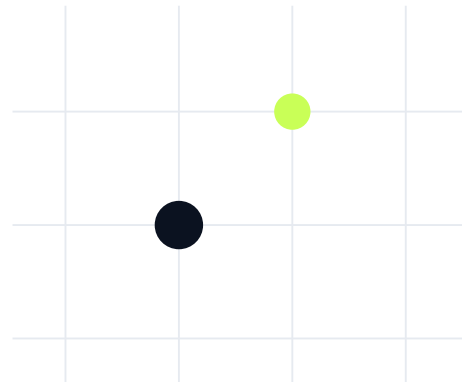


AI READY COLOMBO

Practical AI skills for a changing world.



PROMPT TEMPLATES

Ready-to-use prompts built around the CTCO framework.

Use CTCO when a task needs more than a one-line question

A prompt does not need to sound technical. Give the AI enough context, say what you want, set any limits, and tell it what a useful answer should look like.

Context	What should the AI know about the situation?
Task	What exactly should it do?
Constraints	What limits, rules or boundaries should it follow?
Output	How should the answer be structured?

1. Explain a difficult concept

Use it for: Studying, revision, learning something new

Context: I am learning about [topic] and I understand [what you already know].

Task: Explain [concept] in a way I can understand.

Constraints: Avoid unnecessary jargon. Do not oversimplify the parts that matter.

Output: Give me a short explanation, one example, and three questions I can use to check my understanding.

2. Turn notes into a study plan

Use it for: Exam prep or catching up on a subject

Context: I have [time available] to prepare for [subject/exam]. These are my notes/topics: [paste or list].

Task: Help me turn this into a realistic study plan.

Constraints: Prioritise weak areas and include breaks. Do not assume I can study all day.

Output: Give me a day-by-day plan with the topic, task and estimated time.

3. Improve writing without changing my meaning

Use it for: Emails, reports, applications and assignments

Context: This is a draft I wrote: [paste draft].

Task: Improve the clarity and flow without changing what I mean.

Constraints: Keep my tone. Do not add claims, achievements or facts that are not in the draft.

Output: Return the revised version, then list the main changes in 3-5 short bullets.

Prompts for work, applications and decisions

4. Practise for an interview

Use it for: Internships, graduate roles and job interviews

Context: I am a [student/recent graduate/current role] preparing for a [role] interview. Here is the job description: [paste].

Task: Run a realistic practice interview.

Constraints: Ask one question at a time. Do not invent experience I have not provided.

Output: After each answer, give brief feedback on clarity, evidence and what I could improve.

5. Turn rough notes into an action list

Use it for: Meetings, projects and personal planning

Context: These are my rough notes: [paste notes].

Task: Turn them into a practical action list.

Constraints: Do not invent deadlines or owners. Flag anything that is unclear.

Output: Use a table with Action, Owner, Deadline and Open Question.

6. Compare options before deciding

Use it for: Courses, tools, project choices or purchases

Context: I am choosing between [option A] and [option B]. My priorities are [list priorities].

Task: Compare the options against those priorities.

Constraints: Separate facts from assumptions. Flag any information that needs checking.

Output: Give me a comparison table, then list the questions I should answer before I decide.

7. Stress-test an idea

Use it for: Project plans, proposals and recommendations

Context: I am considering this idea: [describe idea].

Task: Challenge it rather than simply agreeing with me.

Constraints: Focus on realistic weaknesses, missing assumptions and unintended consequences.

Output: Give me the three strongest concerns, what evidence would reduce each concern, and one alternative approach.

Use AI to question your thinking, not just confirm it

8. Ask for the strongest counterargument

Use it for: Essays, opinions, strategy and decision-making

Context: My current view is: [state your view].

Task: Give me the strongest reasonable argument against it.

Constraints: Do not create a weak or exaggerated opposing position.

Output: State the counterargument clearly, the evidence it would rely on, and what my original view may be overlooking.

9. Check a claim before using it

Use it for: Research, presentations and reports

Context: I want to use this claim: [claim].

Task: Help me work out what needs verification.

Constraints: Do not treat your own answer as a source. Do not invent citations.

Output: Identify the parts of the claim that should be checked and suggest what kind of reliable source would verify each one.

10. Build a first draft, then review it

Use it for: Plans, briefs, proposals and structured writing

Context: I need to create [document/task] for [audience/purpose].

Task: Produce a first draft.

Constraints: Use only the information I provide. Mark gaps instead of filling them with guesses.

Output: Give me the draft first. Then add a short section called 'Check before using' with any claims, gaps or assumptions I should review.

Blank CTCO prompt

Context	_____
Task	_____
Constraints	_____
Output	_____